

THE WOODEN O

This model gives us an idea of how the "Wooden O," as Shakespeare called his playhouse, may have looked. It is based on a 1596 sketch of the Swan playhouse, and on descriptions by visitors to the original building. Excavations in 1989 revealed that the Globe was 99 feet (30 m) wide.



Stamp showing the Globe with eight sides (it actually had 20 sides)



The Rose

The Swan

The Globe

FLYING THE FLAG

Each playhouse had its own flag, flown on days when a play was being performed. The flags could be seen across the river in the city, where most of the potential audience lived. The Globe also had a sign above its entrance, depicting Hercules carrying a globe.

TO TILE OR NOT TO TILE?

Most new buildings in London in 1598 had tiled roofs, but the Burbages decided to use layers of straw or reeds called thatch for the roof of the Globe theater. Thatched roofs were far cheaper than tiles, but they were also much more of a fire risk.



Upper rooms, where cannons were fired as a sound effect

Thatched roof shielded the galleries from the weather

In a play, the balcony could represent castle battlements or an upper window

Heavens (stage roof) – the underside was painted to look like a starry sky

Two columns held up the heavens

Stage stuck out into the yard, where the poorest people stood to watch the plays